do something about it for the ODI at Lord's later in the tour – but in the end I wasn't able to play in that game. More recently, when I captained an MCC XI against Shane Warne's Rest of the World XI at Lord's in the Bicentenary Match in July 2014, I raised the problem again. They couldn't increase the height of the sightscreen, but I asked them to make the staircase above it as white as possible, which they did. In the end, I didn't have any problems because Peter Siddle was bowling and he's not as tall as, say, Broad or Tremlett and that makes a huge difference.

I must also confess that while I love Lord's, I always found it difficult to cope with the slope that runs across the ground, no matter how much I tried to work out its effect. I remember facing Chris Lewis once when he was bowling from the Pavilion End. He tended to bowl inswingers and I thought I'd worked out that the slope would bring the ball in to me even more, so I played inside the line – and the ball went the other way and I was bowled!

In 2011, on the evening of the third day of the Lord's Test, I was laid low by a viral infection. My friend Atul Bedade, the former India international and someone who has always supported me at critical times, had come to visit me for the evening, but I realized something was wrong as soon as we got back to the hotel. I asked for a paracetamol from the physio and took it while ordering an early dinner in the room. By 8 p.m. we had finished our meal and I suggested to Atul that he should take off, but Atul didn't want to leave me in that state and kindly decided to sleep on the sofa, so that he could make sure I was all right.

By the middle of the night my condition had worsened and the next morning I was in no state to get up. Atul called Ashish Kaushik, our phsyio, and he advised complete rest. This was the only time in my career I was not able to join the team on the morning of a match. I slept in my hotel room till well after lunch and it was only when I checked the score on television that I called our team manager and told him I was coming to the ground. I wanted to try and play a part in the second innings, as I thought I was needed.

Although I wasn't able to contribute much to the team, I forced myself to field towards the end of the England innings, to make sure I would have an opportunity to bat on day five. At the end of the day's play, I was in a really bad state. To make things worse, when I got back to the hotel I found that the air conditioning in my room had leaked and everything was wet. While I did manage to bat for a while on day five, I was